Fennel and the Big Purple Frustrated

A story about feeling frustrated

by KUZU NOHA

Fennel and the Big Purple Frustrated

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First edition. Printed by Amazon KDP.

For every little bear
with a big feeling.

Fennel wanted to tie his shoes

all by himself – there was nothing to lose!

He made a loop. He made a twirl.

The laces just flopped in a floppy swirl.

He pulled and he pulled. It came out a mess.

He tried once more. And once more. No success.

A purple coil popped out of his chest.

It wound itself tight. It would not rest.

Tighter and tighter, the coil went round.

“I can’t! I can’t!” he said with a frown.

He tossed down his shoe.
It flew through the air.

Papa Bear came and sat on the stair.

“Frustrated is hard,” said Papa. “I know.

Big things take time. We can take it slow.”

“First, PAUSE. Put your shoe down and shake.

Shake out your paws, for goodness' sake!"

“Next, TRY a new way. Make bunny ears two.

Cross them and tuck them.
See what you can do.”

“Last, ASK for a hand. It’s not giving in.

A helping paw is a place to begin.”

Loop, swoop, pull – and the knot held tight!

The purple coil faded from sight.

Now when the purple gets tight and tough,

Fennel knows: Pause. Try. Ask. That's enough!

Fennel's 3 Patient Steps

1. PAUSE

Stop. Put it down. Shake out your paws.

2. TRY

Try a new way.

3. ASK

Ask for a hand or a hint.

Frustrated is okay.

Hard things get easier.

A Note for Grown-Ups

Name the feeling: “You feel frustrated.”

Wait before helping. Let your child pause first.

Show a new way instead of doing it for them.

Praise effort, not only success.

Thank you for reading!

If Fennel helped your little one, a short review on Amazon helps other families find this book.